

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Problems companies face in an IT negotiation!



Learning Outcome:

Understand information about people's backgrounds in spoken or written documents.

Participate in the improvement of IT contracts, establishing technical clauses that respond to the needs of the negotiating agents, based on current laws on contracting.

Can Do Statements:

- I can explain why technology negotiation poses a problem to companies.
- I can list specific problems in technology negotiation.
- I can talk about characteristics for problems in technology negotiation.

Ask your partner:

- Why do you think IT negotiations have become a problem for managers?
- What do you think are the most common problems in an IT negotiation?





Let's Explore!

Sarah is writing an essay on technology negotiation!



Instructions: Read the text below.

Sarah: Professor, can I have a word with you?

Professor: Of course. How may I help you?

Sarah: It's just that I'm stuck on an essay I'm writing about technology negotiation. My hypothesis is basically that technology negotiation has become a huge problem for managers in companies.

Professor: That's right. Nowadays executives are facing negotiations in an ambit that most people know very little about.

Sarah: Are technology negotiations understood differently from other types of negotiation? I mean, shouldn't CEOs always hire experts to deal with this kind of negotiations?

Professor: You are right. The complexity of the topic demands involved knowledge of technical aspects that most managers don't have.

Sarah: But, isn't it necessary for all the people who are concerned with the negotiation to know the terminology at least? Shouldn't communication errors be avoided?

Professor: I partly agree. Sometimes, the ego of those who are taught in technology make them think all the people should know what they are talking about and this often leads to misunderstandings.

Sarah: I see your point. Now, I've found out that sometimes both parties think differently about how the technology will work. Aren't the estimates of the performance of a technology product promised at the first stage of the negotiations?

Professor: In theory, yes. However, there is uncertainty when it comes to complex pieces of technology and it is not so easy to predict how they'll perform in a particular business.

Sarah: What about staff training? Are the organizational changes included in the agreements?

Professor: They should be. The implementation of new technology might derive conflict between both parties. Therefore, it is necessary for negotiators to try to foresee any possible hurdles in the implementation to avoid all these pitfalls.

Sarah: I believe I've clarified my doubts, professor. You've been a great help. Thanks.

Professor: Anytime!





Let's Practice!

The instructor talks about characteristics for problems in technology negotiation.

Instructions: Select the correct answer.

1. Aren't the estimates of the performance of a technology product promised at the first stage of the negotiations?
 - a. Yes. But the performance of complex pieces of technology are poor.
 - b. Yes. But the performance of complex pieces of technology are predictable.
 - c. No because the performance of complex pieces of technology are predictable.
2. Aren't the workers trained to face technology problems?
 - a. They are supposed to be trained monthly.
 - b. Absolutely! They are supposed to be trained monthly.
 - c. Absolutely! They are supposed to be trained monthly.
3. Isn't the implementation of new technology considered a conflict between both parties?
 - a. Only if negotiators foreseeing any possible hurdles.
 - b. No, negotiators don't need to use hurdles
 - c. it's necessary for negotiators to foresee possible hurdles in the implementation to avoid all these pitfalls.
4. Don't you think that the area of negotiation is affected by the rapid increase in the use of information technology specifically?
 - a. Only for suppliers who create new alternatives in order to be in the forefront.
 - b. You're right! It can affect the frequency suppliers who work with a specific quantity of products.
 - c. No, it won't affect anyone.
5. Is sophisticated knowledge of software required over new technology negotiations?
 - a. That's not relevant.
 - b. Unquestionably, this is the most relevant characteristic of problems in technology negotiation.
 - c. Unquestionably, this is the least important characteristic of problems in technology resources.
6. Isn't it necessary for people who are concerned with the negotiation to know the terminology at least?
 - a. I don't agree.
 - b. We don't agree, it's not necessary.
 - c. I partly agree. Sometimes, the ego leads to misunderstandings.





Let's Practice!

Diana asks her friend about why technology negotiation poses a problem to companies.

Instructions: Read the question. Select all the correct answers.

Don't you think that experts need to deal with technology negotiations?

- a. I think it is not so easy to predict how they'll perform in a particular business.
- b. I consider it is necessary to avoid communication faults and build trust.
- c. I believe that they have to know the old terminology in order to avoid misunderstandings.
- d. I think experts who work in technology forget that not all people understand what they are talking about.
- e. I think that executives sometimes have to face negotiations in an ambit that most people know very little about.
- f. I consider that they need to be current with every aspect of technology and business.
- g. I think that experts have to negotiate by using tools of technology.





Extension Activity

It's time to explain why technology could become a problem to companies!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Search information about why technology could represent a problem to companies.
- Write a conversation about why technology could represent a problem to companies.
- Proofread your conversation beforehand in it.
- Share your conversation with your instructor.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I search relevant information about why technology could represent a problem to companies.
- I write a conversation about why technology could represent a problem to companies.
- I proofread my conversation beforehand in it.
- I share the conversation with my instructor.

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Target Words

- **hurdle** (noun): an obstacle.
e.g. Therefore, it is necessary for negotiators to try to foresee any possible hurdles in the implementation to avoid all these pitfalls.
- **misunderstanding** (noun): a disagreement; a comprehension mistake due to a failure in communication.
e.g. Sometimes the ego of those who are taught in technology make them think all the people should know what they are talking about and this often leads to misunderstandings.
- **face** (verb): to confront.
e.g. Nowadays executives are facing negotiations in an ambit that most people know very little about.
- **have a word** (expression): to speak with someone to talk about a specific topic.
e.g. Professor, can I have a word with you?
- **stuck** (adjective): unable to advance.
e.g. It's just that I'm stuck on an essay I'm writing about technology negotiation.
- **ambit** (noun): the range or context of a specific area of interest.
e.g. Nowadays, executives are facing negotiations in an ambit that most people know very little about.



Learning Points

Negative Questions to Express an Opinion

Negative Questions can be used as a conversation strategy.

Negative Questions is a helpful conversation strategy that will help you state opinions in a polite way, and also to suggest agreement on what you say.

Look at the following examples:

***Isn't** the role of a legal counsel to advice objectively?*

***Isn't** complexity a key issue when you negotiate technology?*

***Don't** you think avoiding ambiguity helps the negotiation process?*

These are not real questions, but they are asking the listener to agree with what they state.

Examples

- *Shouldn't CEOs always hire experts to deal with this kind of negotiations?*
- *Aren't the estimates of the performance of a technology product promised at the first stage of the negotiations?*

Simple Present Passive Questions

When we want to give importance to the *Object* of a sentence or when the *Subject* is not important or unknown, the **Passive Voice** is used.

Passive Voice is used in the *Simple* to talk about situations that occur on a regular basis and its doer is unknown or is not important.

To make the simple present passive in, the **to be** verb is used in the *present simple* as the auxiliary at the beginning of the question followed by the object, and then the main verb in its *Past Participle Form*.

To be verb	Object	Main verb (Past Participle)	Complement+ ?
Is	the training schedule	included	in the contract?

Examples

- *Are technology negotiations understood differently from other types of negotiation?*
- *Aren't the estimates of the performance of a technology product promised at the first stage of the negotiations?*

